Comparing Numbers

Which number is bigger? Look at the biggest place first.

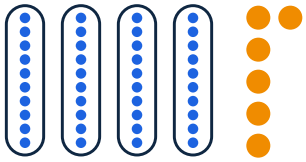
The wide side of the sign faces the bigger number



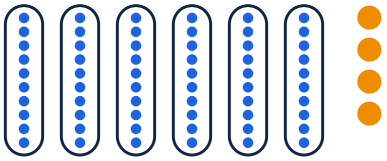
3 < 8

3 is less than 8.
8 > 3: 8 is greater than 3.

46 or 64? Compare the tens first



4 tens



6 tens

46 < 64

352 or 325? Same hundreds, so compare the tens



352



325

352 > 325

Your turn!

471 [>] 417

Write <, > or =

For teachers

Goal: compare by place value with <, > and =. Look at the hundreds first; if they match, the tens; then the ones. Read 46 < 64 as "46 is less than 64." The wide (open) side always faces the bigger number.

Comparing Numbers: Practice

Write <, > or =. The wide side faces the bigger number.

Part 1 Compare the pictures Count the tens first.

1) 

46 < 54

2) 

73 > 37

3) 

58 > 52

4) 

29 < 31

5) 

60 > 59

6) 

85 = 85

Part 2 Compare the drawings Hundreds first. Same hundreds? Look at the tens.

7) 

241 > 214

8) 

132 < 312

Comparing Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 2 Compare the drawings (continued)

9)



305 < 350

10)



423 > 421

Part 3 Which place decides? Circle the place where the numbers are different first.

11) 615 415

hundreds tens ones

12) 483 492

hundreds tens ones

13) 738 735

hundreds tens ones

14) 371 376

hundreds tens ones

15) 509 905

hundreds tens ones

16) 264 284

hundreds tens ones

Part 4 Put them in order Smallest first.

17) 352 235 523

235 < 352 < 523

18) 47 74 44

44 < 47 < 74

19) 608 680 86

86 < 608 < 680

20) 199 910 190

190 < 199 < 910

Comparing Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 5 Two-digit numbers No help this time.

21) 38 < 83	22) 91 > 19	23) 56 < 65
24) 42 < 47	25) 70 > 69	26) 25 = 25
27) 63 > 36	28) 18 < 81	29) 99 > 89
30) 54 > 45	31) 12 < 21	32) 77 > 76

Part 6 Three-digit numbers No help this time.

33) 426 < 624	34) 815 > 518	35) 237 < 273
36) 904 > 409	37) 561 > 516	38) 382 < 832
39) 147 < 174	40) 690 > 609	41) 753 > 735
42) 218 < 812	43) 466 < 646	44) 329 < 392

Comparing Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 7 Same hundreds No help this time. Look past the hundreds.

45) 352 < 359	46) 741 > 714	47) 629 < 692
48) 275 > 257	49) 433 < 434	50) 920 > 902
51) 186 > 168	52) 517 < 571	53) 864 > 846

Part 8 Zeros and equals No help this time. Some are equal.

54) 409 < 490	55) 300 + 40 = 340	56) 507 < 570
57) 60 < 600	58) 200 + 5 = 205	59) 880 > 808
60) 100 > 99	61) 500 + 6 < 560	62) 90 + 9 = 99

Comparing Numbers: Practice (continued)

Part 9 Word problems Compare, then answer.

63) Ana has 46 stickers. Ben has 64 stickers. Who has more stickers?

Number sentence 46 < 64

Answer Ben

Draw or show your work

64) Mia read 125 pages. Leo read 152 pages. Who read fewer pages?

Number sentence 125 < 152

Answer Mia

Draw or show your work

65) A red box holds 308 beads. A blue box holds 380 beads. Which box holds more?

Number sentence 308 < 380

Answer blue box

Draw or show your work

66) Kim scored 250 points. Sam scored 200 + 50 points. Compare them with <, > or =.

Number sentence 250 = 200 + 50

Answer =

Draw or show your work

67) Challenge: Use the digits 4, 7 and 2 once each. What is the biggest number you can make?

Number sentence 7 hundreds 4 tens 2 ones

Answer 742

Draw or show your work